



A smaller Windows 10

Microsoft is trying to reduce the overall size of its upcoming OS so that it uses less storage on devices. More here: <http://dgit.in/Micro10>



Halo 5: Guardians teaser

Halo fans rejoice! Bungie recently revealed a teaser trailer of the upcoming Halo 5: Guardians game. Watch it here: http://dgit.in/Halo5_Guard

Bazaar

Xiaomi Redmi 2

Xiaomi doing what it does best

Incremental innovation with each iteration only advancing by a miniscule amount isn't something that consumers look forward to. However, with the Redmi 2 the change is enough to make it a viable upgrade. The Moto X (2nd Gen) is a good example of this. The device corrects almost every flaw that the older version had, giving us a true flagship smartphone. The same is true for the Xiaomi Redmi 2, which has just been launched in India.

While the smartphone market is flooded with manufacturers now, Xiaomi is a little different. The company has to meet the demands of a consumer base that wants the highest possible specifications at the lowest possible price. That's easier said than done. Take the reaction to the Xiaomi Mi4 for example, the 20k price tag was shunned by many, who expected yet another 14k titan like the Mi3.

This is the path that Xiaomi has chosen though, and looking at the Redmi 2, the company isn't deterred. The newest budget offering from Xiaomi is every bit the device that we expected from them. The company has kept the overall design language followed in the Redmi 1S, but with important changes. The Redmi 2 is slimmer and 15 grams lighter, which adds to its appeal. It's feels very light and just the right size. The overall size is a few millimeters greater than the Moto X (1st Generation).

Moving on, the display on this one remains at 4.7 inch 720p with a Dragontrail glass surface. The Redmi 2 comes with MiUI 6 though, which makes the user interface look way better than the previous OS version. The overall touch experience is smooth and the Dragontrail surface promises an almost complete scratch resistance. Yes, we've tried to scratch it with knives and we've failed.

The display is quite sharp and has a much better overall feel than both the Lenovo A6000 and the Moto E (2nd Gen). The viewing angles are



Price
₹6,999

narrower than what we would have liked, but not too much to be a problem.

Further, since compromise on specs is not an option for Xiaomi, the new Snapdragon 410 64-bit quad core SoC is what powers this device. Benchmark scores go over 20,000 on AnTuTu for this smartphone and it can take pretty much everything that you throw at it. Yes, the GPU on the Snapdragon 410 is not the best, but it's more than satisfactory for the budget segment. The Redmi 2 handles games like Asphalt 8 and Marvel: Contest of Champions with minimum issues.

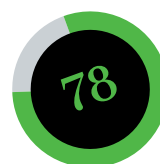
If you've read our review of the Redmi 1S, then you would know that we loved the camera

on that device. The Redmi 2 carries the same 8MP camera, but with MiUI 6 the new camera app that's included greatly increases its potential. For instance, the new camera app now comes with manual exposure control which is very useful. The Redmi 2's camera is better than the Lenovo A6000 and delivers images with higher fidelity and better white balance. It's also pretty good under low light for the price.

Lastly, the area where the Redmi 1S lacked the most was the battery. The 2,200 mAh battery, though still not the best, is at par with the new Moto E and Lenovo A6000, and better than the Redmi 1S (which lasted five and a half hours under our batter test). When we put the Redmi 2 through the same test it ended up lasting for about six and a half hours and on regular usage, we could get it to last an entire day with some amount of frugality.

All said and done, the Redmi 2 is definitely the best budget smartphone to buy right now. At ₹6,999 it provides good value and that improved camera makes a big difference. Xiaomi's flash sales could be an issue for some, but if you can get your hands on one of these then go right ahead.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 4.7-inch 720p;
Processor: 1.2 Ghz
Qualcomm Snapdragon
410 64-bit quad core;
Operating System:
Android 4.4 with MiUI 6;
RAM: 1 GB; **Storage:** 8
GB, expandable to 32 GB;
Camera: 8 MP rear, 2 MP
front; **Battery:** 2200 mAh

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